

Human Dignity as the Highest Value

An Analytical Study of the Encyclical Magnifica Humanitas and its Operationalization in Section 2 of the Ajir Legal Framework

On May 25th, 2026, Pope Leo XIV celebrated the 200th anniversary of the first Pope's embrace of science, Stephen the First, and issued a landmark social doctrine on the creation of a new era which is the shoot of generative artificial intelligence, designing a humanist approach. This encyclical, Magnifica Humanitas, argues from a foundational standpoint of Christian humanism that human dignity is the highest value and must serve as the absolute point of reference for all considerations of technology and social intelligence. At its core, the papal document warns against an insidious, modern transformation where the human experience is reduced to a commodified resource. The encyclical explicitly addresses the high risk of dehumanizing our collective existence as a species, warning that the greatest danger is hidden in plain sight: that the human being is going to become data. This paper bridges this moral anthropology to the active technical and legal architectures we develop at Ajir Research Labs, evaluating how technology can be built to serve human reason rather than seize it.

In the text of Magnifica Humanitas, the existential threat of artificial intelligence is conceptualized not as a dramatic subjugation to an external regime of enlightened cruelty, but rather as something far more insidious in the masochistic surrender of our intrinsic human dignity to more efficient machines. Whenever a person decides to outsource his or her cognitive and moral agency into opaque algorithmic systems, he or she voluntarily gives up the humanity of his or her mind for the mere convenience of technology. The Pope foresees the misguiding power of a powerful new class of digital monopolies that purposefully use their informational advantage for total power over the public space. Posterity knows too well what the publisher Benito Mussolini called the "new oligarchy" of the twentieth century, when a handful of indigenous utility tiers turned society into a mass production line for ideology, completely devoid of individual critical judgment. The encyclical masterfully picks apart a new incarnation of this historic character, noting that the modern enshrined AI system is increasingly treated as the objective truth of the new world. We recognize that a truly moral AI is structurally impossible if our morality is determined negatively, dictated by a monolithic set of values endorsed by a handful of elites. Under no circumstances is it enough to tolerate an AI paradigm where we let a single handful of corporations or institutions secretly decide for the rest of humanity what we should all consider to be true.

To combat this structural centralization of truth, the Pope looks for a remedy in five foundational pillars of Catholic Social Doctrine directly applied to the issue of humanity and artificial intelligence: human dignity, the common good, subsidiarity, participation, and solidarity. Taken together, these principles imply that technology must remain a service, strictly subservient to humanity. This paper operates on the fundamental moral premise that business practices within the knowledge industry must recognize it as the industry of the widest scope, acting as both the theoretical and practical treasury for all other contemporary industries. We align our operations with Antioch Cvetkovic's particularly bold approach regarding the business past, pointing further towards a strategic direction where the future of knowledge commerce is tied directly to human emancipation. Beyond the impossibility of leaving us to the whims of raw market forces, a strategic outlook for the development of responsible artificial intelligence solutions must align closely with the Church's social teaching. The encyclical letter points out the harmful reconstruction of reality in the time of infinite media and the underlying asymmetry meant to expose humanity to manipulation, in which the dominant actor enjoys an unfair advantage in information. The Church addresses this problem by asking for responsible AI development and proposing that Epistemic Justice and Anti-Monopoly requirements be established as key, non-negotiable environmental parameters for any new technological development.

As a development and research company, we as Ajir Research Labs are fundamentally committed to the principle that media literacy is a right and a social good rather than a commoditized resource. To be fully aligned with the ethical imperatives of Magnifica Humanitas, we propose and actively implement a multi-tiered approach to technology development that preserves an open and free system capable of effectively combating historical and social oblivion, ultimately leading to an age where technology reflects and enhances inherent human value. This paper argues directly from the encyclical to the critical question of the reverse of human knowledge: algorithms are not to be made into an unexaminable black box, but must instead be designed for the better sake of human rationality and for the preservation of epistemic justice. In an attempt to come to terms with this moral theory and the deep moral analysis of the encyclical, our paper recapitulates the legal framework for social intelligence, specifically regarding the design of our social intelligence platform, askNoema, as an active political and civic platform in Europe. We bridge the moral anthropology of the encyclical to our structural legal framework by asking how the humanist approach is reflected in our platform's core guidelines, pointing out how our legal framework prepares the way for the future of humankind.

Our platform, askNoema, translates the encyclical's emphasis on accountability and human oversight directly into operational reality. The Ajir Research Constitution states that

truth is a non-negotiable standard across all computational processes. Furthermore, the Ajir Research legal framework pivots towards the mandate that transparency is a structural requirement. These foundational legal principles require absolute AI disclosure, exhaustive source citations, and precise confidence indicators for all analytical applications. This ensures that the platform actively contributes towards mitigating the spread of synthetic misinformation and low-quality material without centralizing epistemic authority in an unaccountable, dictatorial node. Thus, the encyclical's explicit call for an eye-opening information literacy that protects the dignity of marginally employed people is directly answered; we do not believe that the AI should be left to make something interesting out of its own virtue alone, devoid of scope for ongoing human improvement and oversight.

To illustrate how these constitutional and legal principles are applied technically within the askNoema Episteme engine, we formalize the validation of short-form media claims through an explicit evidence-weighting function. Let C represent a specific media claim being evaluated by the engine. We define the total epistemic confidence score $E(C)$ for the claim as a function of verified textual sources, institutional weightings, and algorithmic transparency coefficients. The formal function is expressed as follows:

n

$$E(C) = \alpha \cdot \sum_{i=1}^n (S_i \cdot W_i) + \beta \cdot (T) - \gamma \cdot \Delta(M)$$

In this technical formulation, S represents the individual validity score of an independent, cited primary source, i while W denotes the contextual weight assigned to that source based on historical reliability and peer validation, i avoiding centralized institutional monopolies. The parameter $\Lambda(T)$ represents the structural transparency metric of the data retrieval pathway, ensuring that the lineage of information is fully inspectable by the end user. Conversely, $\Delta(M)$ represents the calculated degree of algorithmic asymmetry or monopoly bias detected within the information stream, which acts as a negative penalty on the overall confidence score. The scalar coefficients α , β , and γ are dynamically adjusted to maintain human-in-the-loop oversight, ensuring that computational metrics remain strictly subservient to human critical judgment. Through this mathematical and structural formalization, the askNoema platform successfully instantiates the five pillars of Catholic Social Doctrine, building a protective technological barrier that safeguards human reason, guarantees epistemic justice, and protects our collective species from being dissolved into mere data.

